

HAIMING (RICHARD) LI

Department of Economics
College of Business, Lehigh University
Bethlehem, PA 18015

Email: hal622@lehigh.edu
Website: haimingli.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Business and Economics	Lehigh University	Expected May 2027
Dissertation: “Three Essays in Health Economics”		
Committee: Chad D. Meyerhoefer (Chair), Jee-Hun Choi, Yulong Wang, Bingjin Xue		
M.S. Applied Economics and Econometrics	University of Southern California	2022
B.S. Business Administration	Beijing Institute of Technology	2019

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Health Economics
Secondary: Applied Econometrics; Industrial Organization

REFERENCES

Chad D. Meyerhoefer (Chair)
Arthur F. Searing Professor and Chairperson
Department of Economics, Lehigh University
chm308@lehigh.edu

Yulong Wang
Associate Professor of Economics
Lehigh University
yuw925@lehigh.edu

Jee-Hun Choi
Assistant Professor of Economics
Lehigh University
jec720@lehigh.edu

Frank R. Gunter
Professor of Economics Emeritus
Lehigh University
frg2@lehigh.edu

RESEARCH

JOB MARKET PAPER

Haiming Li. “Cross-Border Spillovers of Recreational Cannabis Legalization on Mental Health: Evidence from Pennsylvania.”

I estimate how New Jersey’s 2021 recreational cannabis legalization affected psychiatric hospitalizations across the state border in Pennsylvania, which permits only medical use. Combining ZIP code-quarter inpatient discharge records for 2018-2022 with driving times to New Jersey dispensaries, I compare matched ZIP codes in counties near and far from those dispensaries before and after legalization. Psychiatric hospitalizations near the border rose by 1.07 per 1,000 residents per quarter, about 8 percent of the control mean, concentrated in depression, alcohol- and tobacco-related disorders, and dementia and other organic disorders. Evaluations of legalization that stop at the state line omit this cost.

WORKING PAPERS

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Fueling Out of Work: Vehicle Market Restructuring and Labor Supply among Car-Dependent Workers.” *Under Review*

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Policy Spillovers Across Substances: E-Cigarette Regulation, Cannabis Legalization, and Health Outcomes.”

Haiming Li and Bingjin Xue. “Do State Psychiatric Hospital Closures Increase Length of Stay in Acute Care Hospitals? Evidence from Pennsylvania.”

Haiming Li and Chad D. Meyerhoefer. “Does Dental Coverage Reduce the Financial Burden of Heart Disease?”

Chad D. Meyerhoefer, Haiming Li, Erin Ware, John Moeller, Haiyan Chen, Jessica Faul, and Richard Manski. “The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease: A GWAS-by-Subtraction Genomic Structural Equation Instrumental Variables Model.” *Supported by NIH/NIDCR R03DE034043*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Do Foreign Policies Save American Lives? Evidence from China’s Fentanyl Control.”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston, TX (*scheduled*)
Job market paper

2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA (*scheduled*)
Job market paper

2026 American College of Medical Genetics Annual Clinical Genetics Meeting, Baltimore, MD (*poster*)
The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease

2026 ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA (*presented by coauthor*)
The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease

2025 New York State Economics Association Annual Conference, Rochester, NY
Policy Spillovers Across Substances

2023 Pennsylvania Economic Association Annual Conference, Washington, PA
Optimizing Product Protection Plan Premiums

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, NIH/NIDCR R03DE034043 (PI: C. D. Meyerhoefer) Summers 2025, 2026

Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Lehigh University Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

TEACHING

LEHIGH UNIVERSITY

ECO 301/403	Econometric Software	Adjunct Professor	Spring 2027 (<i>scheduled</i>)
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ECO 146	Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis	Adjunct Professor	Summer 2026
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ECO 001	Principles of Economics	Teaching Assistant	2022–2024; Fall 2026
ECO 045	Statistical Methods	Teaching Assistant	Winter 2026
FIN 125	Introduction to Finance	Teaching Assistant	2024–2025

MORAVIAN UNIVERSITY

HHUM 125	Introduction to Health Humanities	Guest Lecturer	February 2026
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TEACHING AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Effective Teaching Practices, Association of College and University Educators (ACUE)	In progress
Strategic Methods for AI-Responsive Teaching (SMART), Lehigh University	Fall 2026

SERVICE

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<i>Journal of Mental Health Policy and Economics</i>	2026
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UNIVERSITY SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Graduate Orientation Ambassador, College of Business, Lehigh University	2025, 2026
President, Lehigh University Chinese Christian Fellowship	2023 – present

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Deacon and Pianist, Lehigh Valley Chinese Christian Church, Bethlehem, PA	2022 – present
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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Computing: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, Mathematica, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$, ArcGIS, Tableau

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic)

Interests: Piano, violin, guitar, and trumpet; tennis